

12.434

EE25BTECH11004 - Aditya Appana

October 12, 2025

Question

The two sides of a parallelogram are given by the vectors $\mathbf{A} = 2\hat{i} - 3\hat{j}$ and $\mathbf{B} = 3\hat{i} + 2\hat{j}$. The area of the parallelogram is:

Solution

Let:

$$\mathbf{a} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -3 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1)$$

$$\mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (2)$$

The area of the parallelogram can be expressed as:

$$\mathbf{a} \times \mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} |\mathbf{A}_{23}\mathbf{B}_{23}| \\ |\mathbf{A}_{31}\mathbf{B}_{31}| \\ |\mathbf{A}_{12}\mathbf{B}_{12}| \end{pmatrix} \quad (3)$$

Substituting values:

$$\mathbf{a} \times \mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 13 \end{pmatrix} \quad (4)$$

Therefore, the area of the parallelogram is:

$$\|\mathbf{a} \times \mathbf{b}\| = 13 \quad (5)$$

It can be seen that $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ are orthogonal, and $\|\mathbf{a}\| = \|\mathbf{b}\|$, therefore they form the sides of a square.

Therefore the area can also be calculated as:

$$\|\mathbf{a}\|^2 = \sqrt{13}^2 = 13 \quad (6)$$

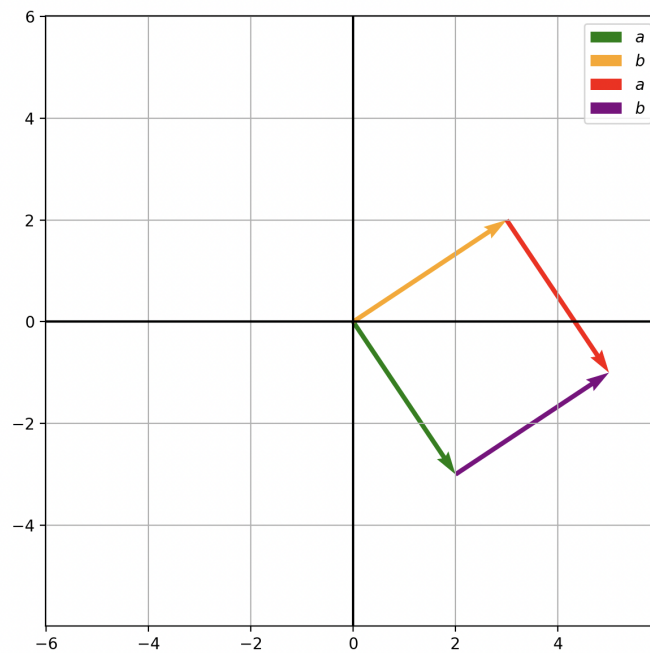


Figure 1: Plot